



"There are more podcasters than listeners"

NIKHIL TANEJA ON WHY HE DOES ONLY EIGHT EPISODES A YEAR, AND THE ONE DETAIL THAT UNLOCKED HIS DEFINING EPISODE

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Nikhil Taneja spent months on the road across 150-odd campuses, listening to some 10,000 young Indians, before he made a single episode. What he heard from the boys – that they were lonely, and no clue how to say so – became *Be A Man, Yaar*, the show he self-funded with several years of his company's profits. Three seasons and 30 episodes later, it has been the number one podcast on Amazon Music and advertised in Times Square.

Taneja is the deliberate opposite of a volume podcaster, making just eight episodes a year, with days of preparation per guest. His defining episode was built on a single detail he noticed in somebody else's interview.

How did you get your podcast idea?

Nikhil: When we started Yuva, about eight years ago, I went to over 150 campuses, met over 10,000 young people. The thing that I would constantly hear from young women was safety issues. At the same time, they would also talk a lot about the community they have around them. They always were speaking about sisterhood. When you give young men a safe space, first, defence mechanism, they joke about it. But the moment the conversation goes deeper, young men would constantly talk about loneliness. In a classroom of 200 people, there would be 150 boys, all of whom are coming and saying,